Abdullah Al Zahid

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SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree and four years across municipal transportation planning at the City of Toronto and GO rail service planning at Metrolinx. Works with municipal divisions, agencies, consultants and applicants whose priorities conflict, reviews development applications against City standards and Official Plan policy, and writes the briefing notes that carry issues to senior staff.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and work issues through to a position everyone can act on.
- Review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them against City standards and Official Plan policy, and recommend conditions where something is missing.
- Advise applicants and staff on transportation planning, by-laws and related regulations, and with policy staff recommend and report to Council on new transportation regulations and guidelines.
- Run assigned studies from scoping through to recommendations, writing the briefing notes that come out of them and presenting to planners, engineers and managers in other divisions.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward.
- Assessed the service effect of temporary and permanent slow orders, the kind of restriction that construction on an operating railway imposes.
- Built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and produced summaries of speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.
- Set up a command line workflow so temporary and permanent slow orders could be pre-simulated in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Worked with large travel datasets and wrote up results for readers without a modelling background.

SKILLS

Coordination across municipal divisions, agencies, consultants and applicants. Development application review against City standards and Official Plan policy. Briefing notes, reports and presentations for senior staff. Rail service planning and the effect of construction on an operating railway. Python (Pandas, NumPy), SQL, ArcGIS Pro and QGIS. MS Office.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)